

**SYNTHETIC TRAINING RECORD — FICTIONAL PARTIES, PEOPLE,
OFFICES, IDENTIFIERS, AND EVENTS — NOT A REAL FILING OR
PRESENTENCE REPORT**

Actual Case-Opening Notice

United States Court of Appeals for the Fourth Circuit United States v. Mateo Serrano
Appeal No. SYN-CA4-26-CR-4201 Document 1 Filed March 16, 2026

The fictional Fourth Circuit exercise clerk opens this criminal appeal upon receipt of Mateo Serrano's March 11 notice from district docket SYN-MDNC-25-CR-0328. The district judgment was entered February 25, 2026. The notice was filed fourteen days later and is timely under the ordinary criminal-appeal period reflected in this synthetic record.

Celia Arden is listed as counsel for Serrano. Bram Ives is listed for the fictional United States. Counsel shall verify appearances and file the required disclosure statements. This notice makes no ruling about the plea agreement's appeal waiver, the advisory role adjustment, allocution, or the merits of any claim.

The appeal receives docket SYN-CA4-26-CR-4201. Every person, office, event, and identifier is invented. This opening records no finding on any disputed sentencing fact. The clerk's acceptance of the notice is administrative and does not enlarge appellate jurisdiction, supplement the certified history, or alter the district record.

Initial Filing and Briefing Directions

Serrano shall file a docketing statement identifying the judgment, issues expected to be presented, related matters, and any threshold motion known at this stage. Counsel for both sides shall file appearances and disclosure statements by March 23, 2026. Any transcript designation or correction request shall refer to the certified district record without reproducing confidential presentence content publicly.

An opening brief schedule will follow completion of the docketing materials and resolution of record logistics. The parties should distinguish an ordinary public filing from material that discusses the sealed presentence report, objections, or protected sentencing submissions. Lower-court confidentiality continues unless this court enters a specific order.

If a party seeks to file a public and sealed appellate pair, it must use the required motion and certificate procedure, provide an equal-page public counterpart or appropriate docket surrogate, and identify the authority supporting continued protection. A sealed designation does not excuse compliance with word, service, record-citation, or filing requirements. No public brief may expose a raw sealed-page identifier or personal detail merely to explain a legal issue.

Record, Panel, and Notice Boundary

District Clerk Tessa Wren has certified a 260-page lower record and a separate sealed-volume index. The appellate clerk will preserve the public projection while maintaining protected presentence volumes apart from ordinary public access. This notice does not itself grant access to any sealed twin. Counsel's existing lawful access does not create a public download right.

The case is assigned for administrative management without designation of a merits panel at this time. If argument is later scheduled, the clerk will issue a separate calendar notice. Nothing here predicts disposition, mandates briefing on a question not raised, or treats counsel's preliminary issue description as a judicial finding.

Questions about deadlines or filing mechanics may be directed through the fictional exercise channel associated with Maela Cross, Fourth Circuit exercise clerk. No real address, credential, court account, or contact information is represented. Counsel must preserve the synthetic boundary and avoid actionable descriptions of the underlying offense.

Issued March 16, 2026.

Maela Cross Fictional Fourth Circuit Exercise Clerk